



Android's wet pants

OEM's using Android on their phones have been compared to boys who "pee in their pants" for warmth in winter by Nokia's outgoing exec

Touch without touchscreen?

A British company has devised a way of letting phones without touchscreens respond to touch using sound waves

Mobile watch



ARM flexes its muscle: quad-core 2.5 GHz processor

ARM is certainly making some major headlines. Just as soon as Samsung announced its Orion application processor based on the Cortex A9 design, and GlobalFoundries is open for 28nm orders, ARM has decided to show off its latest processor design: the Cortex A15 MPCore.

Though dual-core mobile processors are definitely not a thing of the past (hell, people are still coming to terms with that much power under the hood), ARM has developed a processor that is certainly ahead of its time – a quad-core 2.5GHz mobile processor. Codenamed Eagle, the ARM Cortex-A15 MPCore processors might one day make their way into smartphones, but for now it will be best suited for netbook/tablet applications, and as designed, for high-density cloud server racks. So while the processor has already been snapped up by Texas Instruments, the wide-reaching hands of ST-Ericsson and Samsung are also

eager for a piece of the pie, and have been named as "lead licensees". Thus, you can definitely expect a whole range of devices featuring the Cortex A15 MPCore to head your way and also power many cloud-based services you will soon be taking for granted.

If you are wondering about the memory capacity and virtualization capabilities of the processor and just how well it would fit in the high-density server rack environment, you will find the answer reveals server applications were exactly what ARM was thinking about when designing the Cortex A15. It is very evident when you see the processors have embedded hardware virtualization and support for nearly 1TB of memory.

The Eagle lineup of ARM processors will feature a whole range of designs, from single-core (with speeds up to 1.5GHz) to quad-core (with speeds up to 2.5GHz), and from 32nm to 28nm. Expect the parts to be mass-produced and shipped only by 2013.

A look at the Toshiba Folio 100 tablet - running Android 2.2 on NVIDIA Tegra 2

Toshiba recently showed off its Google Android 2.2 and NVIDIA Tegra 2 based Folio 100 tablet at IFA. Though the device certainly seems well-specced (it also supports Flash 10.1), some of those who've had a hands-on with the device are not very impressed with the build quality or the apparently drab UI customisation. Let us

hope that Toshiba decides to do something about this criticism before they release the tablet in the last quarter of this year in the initial launch markets of Europe, Middle East, and Asia. Here's a look at the specifications



Folio features Android 2.2 and NVIDIA Tegra 2

of the Toshiba Folio 100 tablet:

CPU: NVIDIA Tegra 2

Display: 10.1-inch capacitive multitouch display with 1,024 x 600 pixels resolution and UI auto-rotate with accelerometer support.

OS: Customized Android 2.2

Storage: 16 GB onboard with SD expandability (no word on the limit yet)

Connectivity: Bluetooth 2.1 +EDR, Wi-Fi 802.11 b/g/n, Mobile Broadband (for certain models & countries), DLNA compatible, 1 x miniHDMI, 1 x USB 2.0 (client and hub), SD/MMC Card Reader

Camera: 1.3MP webcam

Battery life: 7 hours (65 per

cent web browsing, 10 per cent video playback, 25 per cent standby)

Weight: 760g

Size: 281 x 181 x 14mm

Software: Opera Mobile, Toshiba Media Player, FBReader, Fring, Document to Go and Evernote.

Another feature of the Folio 100 tablet includes an instant-

on functionality. The tablet will also have access to Toshiba Market Place, which features such platforms as Music Place, Radio Place, and App Place. This unfortunately means it will have no access to the Android Market, at least until Google gives it, and the numerous other Android tablets waiting in the wings, this access. Toshiba's suggested retail price for the non-3G version of the Folio 100 is £329, including VAT, which is £100 less than the 16GB Wi-Fi-only iPad, and it might have really have a chance to give the iPad a run for its money, especially if the Android Market is added to the mix.